

STUDENT BRANCH OF THE AMERICAN INSTITUTE OF AERONAUTICS AND ASTRONAUTICS

ARTICLE I - NAME

Section 1 The name of this organization shall be the University of Texas at Austin student branch of the American Institute of Aeronautics and Astronautics (AIAA).

ARTICLE II - OBJECTIVE

Section 1 The objective of this organization is to further, within its institution, the purposes and programs of AIAA (the Institute). Additionally, the student branch is established to highlight to their university and local community the value of the aerospace industry and the role played by AIAA. Organizationally, student branches are part of the AIAA Regional Engagement Activities Division (READ).

ARTICLE III - UNIVERSITY COMPLIANCE

Section 1 This organization is a recognized student organization at The University of Texas at Austin and shall comply with all campus policies as set forth in the Institutional Rules on Student Services and Activities and Information on Students' Rights and Responsibilities.

ARTICLE IV - PROHIBITION OF HAZING

Section 1 State law and Sec. 6-404 of the Institutional Rules on Student Services and Activities and Information on Students' Rights and Responsibilities define hazing as any intentional, knowing or reckless act, occurring on or off the campus of an educational institution, by one person alone or acting with others, directed against a student, that endangers the mental or physical health or safety of a student for the purpose of pledging, being initiated into, affiliating with, holding office in or maintaining membership in any organization whose members are or include students at an educational institution.

ARTICLE V - MEMBERSHIP

- Section 1** Any full-time graduate or undergraduate student at the University of Texas at Austin that is a current member of AIAA is considered to be a member of this student branch by AIAA. Eligibility for membership in the student branch or to be elected or appointed to a student officer position may not be limited on the basis of race, religion, national origin, ethnicity, color, age, gender, gender identity, marital status, citizenship, sexual orientation, or disability, and there shall be no rules or policies of the organization that discriminate on the basis of these factors.
- Section 2** Branch members are not required to be current members of AIAA. Membership in AIAA and associated dues shall be as fixed by AIAA and shall be paid to the Institute. The branch may levy additional local dues, which may be used to fund or subsidize activities of the branch. The benefits of these additional local dues may be limited to that subset of members that provided the funds. However, membership in AIAA or this student branch shall not be contingent on the payment of any local dues.

ARTICLE VI - OFFICERS

- Section 1** The Executive Committee shall consist of a Chair, Vice Chair, Secretary, and Treasurer. The Executive Committee shall create other elected officer positions based upon the needs of the individual branch. If an officer, other than the Chair, is unable to perform his/her duties or no longer meets the requirements of the officer position, the Chair, with approval of the Executive Council and the Faculty Advisor, may appoint a member to serve in his/her seat for the remainder of the term of office. A vacancy in the office of Chair is filled by the Vice Chair.
- Section 2** All officers shall be elected for a term of one year. There are no term limits on branch officers.
- Section 3.1** The officers of the student branch shall be chosen from among the branch members. All members are eligible to run for open officer positions. Officers are determined by the annual nomination process and elections. The election process is outlined in Article VIII.
- Section 4.1**
President The duties of the President shall be to preside at all regular meetings of the organization, to preside at all meetings of the Executive Committee, and to serve as an ex-officio member of all other branch committees. At the end

of the academic year, the President shall submit to AIAA a report of the activities of the student branch for the year.

- Section 4.2**
*Vice President:
Internal* The Vice President (Internal) is responsible for handling internal duties of the organization and to assist the President, especially when the President is unable to attend.
- Section 4.3**
*Vice President:
External* The Vice President (External) is responsible for handling external duties of the organization, including being the corporate liaison and the main point of contact of the organization for corporate representatives.
- Section 4.4**
Treasurer The Treasurer shall have charge of the funds of the student branch and shall make all required financial reports and expenditures authorized by the student branch or Executive Committee.
- Section 4.5**
Secretary The Secretary shall maintain minutes of the meetings of the student branch and shall be custodian of all its records not specifically assigned to others. They shall conduct the correspondence of the student branch and Executive Committee and send out notices of the meetings and shall keep a full and correct list of the members and their addresses. They shall also be responsible for reserving rooms and facilities for all organizational meetings and events.
- Section 4.6**
Social Chair The Social Chair is responsible for running all social media accounts of the organization (Instagram & LinkedIn), creating engaging social media posts to promote club events to current and new members, and planning a social one or twice a semester.
- Section 4.7**
*Competitions
Chair* The Competitions Chair is in charge of overseeing the AIAA Design Competition, and will work to find other competitions that AIAA can compete in. In addition, the Competition Chair is responsible for ensuring that members competing remain active while kicking/replacing inactive members.
- Section 4.8**
*Freshman
Representatives* The Freshman Representatives are expected to find new ways to introduce freshman students within the organization and to train to become an officer in later years. This position shall be held by two members, who will share responsibilities equally and be elected together as a pair.
- Section 4.9**
Cockrell The CRC is required to attend monthly Cockrell Relations Meetings & SEC voting meetings, to keep AIAA informed about developments in

<i>Relations Chair</i>	Cockrell and the engineering community, and to coordinate socials and events with other student organizations.
Section 4.10 <i>Webmaster</i>	The Webmaster is responsible for overseeing the development of AIAA - UT's website, making it an appealing and useful resource for students, faculty, and industry. In addition, the webmaster will collaborate with the social media chair in planning a social once a semester.
Section 4.11 <i>Admin Officer</i>	The Admin Officer is expected to maintain membership records and support members with obtaining national AIAA membership. In addition, the admin officer is expected to assist the other AIAA officers when needed.

ARTICLE VII - MEETINGS

Section 1	The student branch is encouraged to hold at least four meetings per academic-year. Special meetings of the branch may be held at the call of the Chair or upon written request of 20% of the membership.
Section 2	Any events not considered a general meeting shall be held as deemed necessary by the Executive Committee.

ARTICLE VIII - ELECTIONS

Section 1	As mentioned in Article VI.3.1, all members of the student branch can apply for eligible positions and vote. There shall be no minimum number of members required to be present at election meetings, and no minimum number of votes required to win. Members shall be notified at least fourteen (14) days prior to the scheduled election.
Section 2	All candidates for officer positions shall undergo an interview with the Executive Committee. Following the interviews, the committee will select at least two qualified candidates per position to advance to the general election.
Section 3	Candidates shall be given an opportunity to speak before a candidate-blind vote is held. All candidates for the position must leave the room while votes are discussed and tallied. During this time, members may speak in favor of or against any candidate.

Officers with no relation to the candidates shall administer the vote counting and announce the results within three to five business days following the election.

Section 4 Any officer is liable to be removed if deemed necessary by the faculty advisor and officer team. Removal shall be considered necessary in cases including, but not limited to:

- (a) Failure to fulfil necessary duties
- (b) Conduct unbecoming of an officer
- (c) Violation of organization or university regulations

Before removal, the officer shall be notified in writing of the concerns and given an opportunity to respond at a meeting with the faculty advisor and officer team.

ARTICLE IX - FINANCIAL AFFAIRS

Financial Affairs

Section 1 Student branch may charge local dues under the limitations of Article V.1 and/or conduct fundraising. The latter may include applying for funds from their own department/school/university, local industries, the local professional AIAA Section, or READ. The fiscal year shall be defined in the READ policies and procedures.

Section 2 The student branch shall have no indebtedness, and shall not enter into any contract or understanding, assume any obligations, or make any expenditures, the effect of which would be to create, at any time, a branch obligation the total amount of which exceeds \$100 over the funds on hand.

Section 3 In the event that the student branch should go through dissolution, all assets shall be transferred to the university where the organization was established, or to AIAA.

ARTICLE X - COMMITTEES

- Section 1** There shall be as many committees with as many members as deemed necessary by the student branch membership to carry on the work of the branch. A committee can be formed for the purpose of one specific task and then sunset or as a perpetual group that provides a specific function.
- Section 2** Committee chairs are appointed by the Student Branch Chair with the approval of Article VI Branch officers

ARTICLE XI - UNIVERSITY ADVISOR

- Section 1** In accordance with Sec. 6-101 (6) of the Institutional Rules on Student Services and Activities and Information on Students' Rights and Responsibilities, this organization may have a University Advisor who is at least twenty-one years of age, is not enrolled as a student at the University, and serves as either:
- (a) a part-time or full-time employee of the University.
 - (b) a representative of a national organization that is associated with the registered student organization (registered student organizations only).
- Section 2** To assure continuity of purpose and activities as well as conformity with the rules and regulations governing student activities at the institution, the student branch shall have an official faculty advisor listed in the records of the AIAA READ Student Branch Committee (SBC). The faculty advisor must be in the employ of the university and be a current AIAA member that has agreed to serve in this capacity.
- Section 3** The student branch may designate additional unofficial advisors beyond the official faculty advisor. These additional advisors need not be faculty members.
- Section 4** The following shall be communicated to READ through the Student Branch AIAA staff liaison or the annual activity report:
- (a) A change in the official faculty advisor of the student branch.
 - (b) The election or appointment of new student branch officers.
 - (c) Information on branch programs and activities for potential release to the AIAA publications.

ARTICLE XII - AMENDMENTS & LIMITATIONS

- Section 1** In accordance with the AIAA Constitution and bylaws, the student branch membership and student branch bylaws are governed by the AIAA Certificate of Incorporation, the Constitution, bylaws, and policies of the Institute, as well as any rules or regulations established by the AIAA Board of Trustees.
- Section 2** Student Branches must comply with the laws of local or national authorities, and with all University policies, procedures, and practices, which shall supersede these bylaws in instances of conflict.
- Section 3** Policy and Procedure documents to augment these bylaws may be approved by a two-thirds affirmative vote of those student branch members present at a special meeting called for the express purpose of approving Policy and Procedures. Such a meeting must be announced at least 10 days in advance. Policy and Procedure documents may be proposed by the Executive Committee or by a member petition to the Secretary, as long as at least 10% of the membership or five members (whichever is greater) endorses such a petition. No policy or procedure document that is inconsistent with the bylaws or the constitution of AIAA shall be submitted to vote.
- Section 4** READ may from time to time amend or alter these bylaws for reasons including, but not limited to, keeping these bylaws in alignment with the Constitution, bylaws, and standing policies of the Institute.
- Section 5** All amendments or changes to this constitution must be reflected in an updated constitution that must be submitted to Student Activities in the Office of the Dean of Students within 14 days of its approval.

Article XIII - FORMATION & TERMINATION

Section 3 The AIAA Board of Trustees is empowered to establish or terminate student branches in the manner set forth within the bylaws of AIAA and the policies established by the Board of Trustees.

Section 4 Upon the termination of a student branch, the student branch shall halt the commitment of student branch funds. Debts already incurred for spending previously authorized by the student branch in accordance with Article VIII shall be paid. No future payments may be authorized or debts incurred after a student branch is terminated and all planned and approved future spending shall be voided. The student branch shall return all remaining funds as per Article VIII.2 and close any financial accounts of the student branch.

Certified as correct:

Faculty Advisor

Chair

Date